Project Close-out

Finish well: check what was achieved, hand over cleanly, capture what you learned, tie up loose ends and say thank you.

Run a Project · Close · Benefits Realisation · Lessons Learned

PROJECT _____

DATE _____

1 Did We Achieve It?

AGAINST THE ORIGINAL GOAL

Original goal: _____

What we delivered: _____

MEASURE	TARGET	ACTUAL	WHAT IT TELLS US

2 Benefits Still to Come

MOST VALUE ARRIVES AFTER THE PROJECT ENDS

BENEFIT	EXPECTED BY	MEASURED HOW	OWNER

3 Handover

WHO OWNS IT NOW?

- [ ] Support team trained and ready
- [ ] Documentation and runbooks handed over
- [ ] Open defects and backlog given an owner
- [ ] Monitoring and alerts owned
- [ ] Access, licences and accounts sorted
- [ ] Contracts and suppliers closed
- [ ] Budget closed and reported

Handed to: _____

4 What We Learned

FOR THE NEXT PROJECT, NOT FOR THE ARCHIVE

KEEP DOING

What worked that we'd repeat?

DO DIFFERENTLY

What would we change?

SURPRISES

What did we not see coming?

5 Loose Ends

NOTHING LEFT WITHOUT AN OWNER

ITEM	OWNER	BY WHEN

6 Thanks & Celebrate

People and teams to thank: _____

How we'll celebrate: _____

Share the story and lessons with: _____

"What would we tell the next team that runs a project like this?"

"Who will check the benefits arrived, and when?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/better-delivery-toolkit